Commentary on the King of Tantras Called Hevajra

Toh 1188 · Derge Tengyur
ཀཱཏྲྱེ་རྡོ་རྗེ་ཞེས་བ་བྱའ་རྒྱུད་ཀྱི་རྒྱལ་པོའི་འགྲེལ་པ

This work, which its colophon calls the Commentary on the King of Tantras Called Hevajra, is an explanation of the difficult points of the Hevajra Tantra, one of the principal yoginī tantras, composed by the Indian master Padmāṅkuravajra. The text as given here opens in the midst of its comments on the tantra's first chapter, at the celebrated verse teaching that great gnosis abides in the body, free of all conceptual thought and pervading all things, yet is not born from the body; there the commentator shows that the Tathāgata is omniscient and refutes those who say that gnosis comes from a transformation of the body, as drunkenness comes from liquor. Explaining the tantra's words and phrases, it continues through the chapters of the first part to the end of the eleventh, then treats the second part briefly with an account of the four empowerments, the vase, secret, wisdom-gnosis and fourth empowerments, and closes with the author's verses of humility and dedication. Its colophon records that, at the request made to the great Indian preceptor Padmākara by Tsurtön Yikgi Gyaltsen and others, it was translated into Tibetan by Rinchen Barwa. It is Toh 1188 in the Tengyur, where it belongs among the commentaries on the tantras.

Because it does this, it is called "abiding in the body." The afflictions and the obscuration of the knowable, together with their habitual tendencies: the abandoning of precisely these is called "having abandoned all conceptual thought." For example, just as the moon, rising in a stainless sky, illuminates all substantial things, so the Tathāgata, being free of obscurations, knows by himself and makes others understand. Therefore it is called "pervading all substantial things." This shows that the Tathāgata is omniscient.

Others say, "Gnosis comes from the transformation of the body." They say, "It is like becoming drunk on liquor." To dispel that wrong view comes the passage beginning "Though it abides in the body, it is not born from it." If gnosis came from the transformation of the body, why would consciousness come from elsewhere and enter between the two, semen and blood? At the time of death, it is not tenable that consciousness should arise in the body. Therefore that view is declared to be wrong.

The channels are the paths by which consciousness goes and comes. What are the channels, and how many are there? In the passage beginning "There are thirty-two channels," they are called "thirty-two" on account of a numerical correspondence. This is the worldly convention. I shall set out their names and locations later. "The place of great bliss" is the head. The channels pervade and abide from the head down to the soles of the feet. Breath, the life-wind, and bodhicitta, these three, are the companions of consciousness. These three move in the channels.

On the passage beginning "Among them, three channels are principal": why are they called "principal"? They draw in, they hold, and they send out; that is why they are called "principal." The one that draws in and sends out on the left side of the body is Lalanā. The one that draws in and sends out on the right side is Rasanā. The one that makes it remain in between is Avadhūtī. Ultimately, these are one. For example, a single rope is tied to a tree, and children and others swing on it. In the same way, the navel maṇḍala is like the place where the child sets its feet. Why is it called "in between"? It is called "in between" because the wind that has entered within rests there. When consciousness comes to abide there, it becomes free of all conceptual elaboration.

On the passage beginning "Avadhūtī in the central region": through the relation of support and supported, Avadhūtī is said to be free of apprehended and apprehender. Abhedyā is said to be located at the heart. Sūkṣmarūpā is at the forehead. Divyā is between the two eyebrows. Vāmā is at the tip of the long rib on the left side. Vāminī is at the tip of the long rib on the right side. Kūrmajā is beside the joint on the right side. Bhāvakī is on the left side of the joint. Sekā is inside the gullet. Doṣavatī is below the space between the two testicles. Viṣṭā is in the secret passage. The Mātṛkās are at the two eyebrows. Śarvarī is at the right ear. Śītadā is at the left ear. Ūṣmā is below the navel. Pramāṇā is in the lungs. Kṛṣṇavarṇā is in the liver. Sāmānyā is in the hollow behind the right knee. Hetudāyikā is in the hollow behind the left knee. Viyogā is on the inner side of the right forearm. Premaṇī is on the inner side of the left forearm. Siddhā is at the lower end of the right leg. Pāvakī is at the lower end of the left leg. Sumanā is in the supreme one. Trivṛttā is the one that winds around Avadhūtī. Kāminī is at the two shoulders. Gehā is in the intestines. Caṇḍikā is in the hollow at the nape of the neck. Karkatani is at the two breasts. Māradārikā is at the two sides of the secret vajra.

As for "the three existences," the arising of the three, body, speech, and mind, is also called "the three existences." It is in order to bring this about that the channels come into being. If there were no channels, bodhicitta, the self-arisen flower, and consciousness would not come together; so they are shown to be the cause of body, speech, and mind. Because of that cause, the channels are regarded as having the nature of existence.

"I shall teach the divisions of restraint": it is called "restraint" (saṃvara) because it restrains one from the six classes of beings. Since it has divisions, such as that of the hearers (śrāvakas), it is called "divisions." Alternatively, it is called "restraint" because it comprehends all aspects without abandoning either the conventional or the ultimate.

"āli kāli," the vowels and consonants, have the nature of the moon and the sun, the left and the right, night and day, method and wisdom, and so forth. "Thirty-two lotus petals" means that thirty-two channels abide in the body through their numerical correspondence with the going and coming of the breath. Their purity is the thirty-two lotus petals. In the same manner, the purity of the sixty-four yak-tail whisks is the sixty-four lotus petals. For the two movements of the breath, outward and inward, by day and by night, the two sets of sixteen are counted as one; through the correspondence of that number there are the sixteen transitions of time. Their purity is the sixteen lotus petals. In a day and night there are eight watches (praharas). Their purity is the eight lotus petals. As for "the four kinds of watches," their purity is the four cakras.

Since without performing the fire offering (homa) one does not obtain worldly and world-transcending accomplishments, one should understand the fire offering within the body. Therefore, on the passage beginning "Caṇḍālī blazes at the navel": here the navel maṇḍala is the fire pit, and in its center the action of the fire offering is to be performed. "Caṇḍālī" is wisdom. What is the nature of that wisdom like? It is each one's own understanding. It blazes through the yoga of the vajra and the lotus. Why is it called "blazing"? It is called "blazing" because it has risen up. "The five Tathāgatas" are the five kinds of conceptual thought. "Burns" means that it eliminates them.

"Locanā and the others" are the elements, the sense sources, and the aggregates. These are the firewood. "Burns" means that it burns what has just been explained. To show that at the end one should pour with the ladle, there is the line "When haṃ is burned, the moon melts." This means that when all

the firewood has been burned, the body cakra together with haṃ, its mouth turned downward, melts. That has the nature of the ladle. What has just been explained above is what is called "melting." What is it that melts? Bodhicitta melts, in the nature of nectar. Its form is like melted butter poured from the ladle. Through the delight this brings, whatever result is desired is bestowed.

The commentary on the first chapter of the Hevajra, composed by Padmāṅkuravajra, is complete.

The rite for bringing down rain, dispersing clouds, the practice of chalk and its accomplishment, the rite for burning fever, vomiting up liquor, bringing under control, and seizing the sun and moon: these are called the minor accomplishments. As the yoga by which the first of these is accomplished, one should meditate on the sixteen-armed Hevajra. For the others, in order, there are Vajrī, Gaurī, Vārī, Vajraḍākinī, Nairātmyā, Bhūcarī, and Khecarī. Through the yoga of these seven, each should be accomplished separately. Teaching them separately in this way is given only as an illustration; it is taught that even through a single one, all the accomplishments are achieved. Why is it taught only as an illustration? Although all of them are capable, what is shown is the one principal for each activity. Therefore it is stated only as an illustration. These words show that the minor accomplishments are achieved through deity yoga alone.

What is the accomplishment of the Great Seal (mahāmudrā)? It is the state of a Tathāgata. And the activity of a Tathāgata is working for the benefit of sentient beings. Since that is not achieved without the four methods, the four methods are approach, near approach, accomplishment, and great accomplishment; and their varieties are approach, intermediate, great, and greater still. What meaning do these words teach? The vajra ground and the protection wheel; in its center, the maṇḍala wheel; and in its center, the body perfected through the stages of full awakening. Then it melts. Then the four goddesses exhort it and make the principal deity rise up. Then come the blessing of his sense sources, the blessing by the four cakras, and the empowerment. Just as for oneself, the same should be done for the wisdom consort and for the deities of the maṇḍala wheel too. Without these, the accomplishment of the Great Seal will not be achieved. The meaning of these is taught by the Tathāgata; hence:

First, for the sake of awakening to emptiness;
second, the seed is fully grasped;

third, the image is accomplished;
and in the fourth, the syllables are set out.

The commentary on the second chapter of the Hevajra, composed by Padmāṅkuravajra, is complete.

"One should contemplate loving-kindness" means showing what is beneficial and bestowing happiness. Such a mind is called loving-kindness. Wishing all sentient beings to be free of both suffering and the continuum of suffering is called compassion. Delighting in gladdening, oneself, the unhappy minds of all sentient beings, and in giving whatever they wish, is what is meant by "Third, one should contemplate joy." Not taking on even a single fault on account of sentient beings who are hard to tame, who cannot be tamed without skillful means, and who are possessed of great attachment is called equanimity.

On the passage beginning "First, for the sake of awakening to emptiness": through these lines the four branches, approach and the rest, are taught, namely approach, near approach, accomplishment, and great accomplishment. I shall teach the results of these four: the concordant result, the result of maturation, the result of personal effort, and the stainless result. Now I shall explain the characteristics of the four branches together with their results. The rising of the principal deity, exhorted by the four goddesses, is called the branch of approach and the concordant result. The blessing of the sense sources, the eye and the rest, is called the branch of near accomplishment of approach and the result of maturation. The blessing by the four cakras is called the accomplishment of approach and the result of personal effort. The empowerment is called the great accomplishment of approach and the stainless result. The completion of the wisdom consort's body as well, and the rest, are called the four branches of intermediate approach and accomplishment. Their four results should be understood in the same way. The completion of the bodies of the deities of the maṇḍala wheel, and the rest, are called the four branches of great approach and accomplishment. The concordant result and the rest are called the four great results. The passage beginning "First, emptiness" is shown to be the general cause of the approach of approach and the rest.

I shall explain its particulars:

Meditate in front on a sun transformed from raṃ;
upon that very sun,

from hūṃ arises the crossed vajra.

From that vajra, vajras are emanated again and again, and from these one should imagine the vajra ground. Then come the vajra fence and the vajra lattice; one should imagine these. On the passage beginning "First, one should imagine the corpse": within the maṇḍala wheel one should generate an eight-petaled lotus, and on its anthers imagine the great field (the corpse). "Imagine the syllable raṃ at one's own heart" means that the yogin should sit in a pleasing place and then imagine the syllable raṃ at his own heart. Its transformation is a sun disc; upon that one should imagine hūṃ itself, and from that a vajra. In its central bulb one should imagine hūṃ. It radiates immeasurable rays of light, which summon Heruka together with the eight goddesses, Gaurī and the rest; one should imagine them in the sky. One emanates Gaurī and the others from one's own heart and imagines that outer, inner, and secret offerings are made. Then, in their presence, one should do the confession of misdeeds and the rest. Then one requests them to depart.

Upon the great field, whose nature is the dharmadhātu, as taught before: on the passage beginning "āli kāli," the vowels and consonants, one should imagine a moon disc from a and the rest. From ka and the rest one should imagine a sun disc. Between these two one should imagine the seed. The seed should be understood in connection with the passage above beginning "Black in color and terrifying." From the transformation of hūṃ one should imagine a vajra. It should be understood as marked with hūṃ. In this way one should meditate. The sun and moon, and those vajras together with the hūṃ in the vajra's central bulb, are blue in color. This should be understood in connection with the passage beginning "From the transformation of all of these, a great black one filled with vajras." What do these words teach? Through the stages of the fivefold full awakening, the yogin should meditate on Heruka upon the great field taught above. What has just been explained should be understood in connection with the earlier passage beginning "First, one should imagine the corpse."

"That itself is declared to be what is called the Being": this should be understood in connection with what follows. That word refers to Vajrasattva himself. "The supreme bliss (saṃvara) whose nature is joy" means "the nature of all sentient beings."

On the passage beginning "Having drawn them in at the heart, one fully gathers them": by the sound of the vajra and the lotus one should summon all the Tathāgatas and imagine them entering one's heart. They melt into bodhicitta, and one should let it descend into the lotus. From that one should emanate yoginīs like one's own body. Having emanated them, one should make them pervade all the realms of space. Then, drawing them back again, one should set them out in the maṇḍala. Just as the eight-faced Hevajra was taught to melt, so this one too melts. Exhorted by the song of the four goddesses, he should be made to rise. To make its meaning understood, it is taught by the passage beginning "The yogin becomes the very self of aversion." This shows the nature of the result. The passage beginning "Blue in color, faintly smiling, red" shows the qualities of the result. In the same sequence, it should be understood that the four-armed and the six-armed forms also rise.

The commentary on the third chapter of the Hevajra, composed by Padmāṅkuravajra, is complete.

For example, just as one who has not been consecrated as king cannot perform the duties of a king, so a Tathāgata cannot teach the Dharma without being empowered as king of the Dharma. Therefore I shall explain the chapter on empowerment. "Having radiated light from one's own heart" means that one is perfected through the stages of the fivefold full awakening. Then the seed becomes like a moon. Through the power of the exhortation addressed to it, it rises. In it one should bless the four cakras. Then light rays radiate from the seed abiding in the heart cakra and summon the Tathāgatas dwelling in the ten directions. "Black light rays like hooks" means this: in the right eye one imagines a sun arising from ma. In the left eye one should imagine a moon arising from ṭa. From these one should radiate light rays like hooks. Then one should perform the gaze of summoning. Then one should roll the eyes and flutter the eyelashes. These words teach the perfecting of Heruka. The yogin who, in this sequence, constantly meditates in the supreme way on the branch of approach and the rest at the three times will attain the accomplishment of the Great Seal. Such is the meaning that is taught. In what words is it taught? It is said: "The supreme accomplishment is achieved through the nectar of gnosis."

The commentary on the fourth chapter of the Hevajra, composed by Padmāṅkuravajra, is complete.

On the passage beginning "By nature there is no form": here form is of two kinds, color and shape. Its subdivisions are twenty: blue, yellow, red, white, long, short, round, even, high, low, square, uneven, cloud, smoke, dust, mist, shadow, sunlight, light, and darkness. As for light, there are the moon, the stars, fire, medicinal herbs, and jewels; their rays are called "light."

On "There is no sound, nor any hearer": sound is of eight kinds: produced sound arising from the great elements as its cause, unproduced sound arising from the great elements as its cause, the sound of sentient beings, sound not of sentient beings, pleasant sound, and unpleasant sound. The sound of clapping the hands and the like is called produced sound arising from the great elements as its cause. The sounds of wind, forests, and rivers are called unproduced sound arising from the great elements as its cause. The sound of speech is called the sound of sentient beings. The sound of echoes and the like is called sound not of sentient beings.

On "There is no smell, nor anyone who senses it": smell is of four kinds: fragrant smell, foul smell, a mixture of the two smells, and neither. On "There is no taste, nor any taster": taste is of six kinds: sweet, sour, bitter, salty, pungent, and astringent. On "There is no touch, nor any toucher": touch is of eleven kinds: the four great elements, extreme cold, extreme warmth, a mixture of these two, smoothness, roughness, a mixture of these two, and neither.

How is it that these do not exist? Neither a single atom nor many atoms exist. How do they not exist? Since no beginning, end, or middle is found in a single atom, there is no single one. Therefore there are not many either. For that reason, there is no person who abides permanently through the three times and enjoys experience. Why is there no enjoying in the three times? The past has ceased, the future is unborn, and the time in between does not remain, just as a white mustard seed does not stay on the tip of a needle.

The words of the passage beginning "The mother and" show that ultimately there is no relationship. Why is there ultimately no relationship? Because it is a matter of mutual dependence. What is unborn has no dependence. Why does it have no dependence? Because it is nonexistent.

What exists by intrinsic nature has no dependence.

The passage beginning "Likewise the dancer and the dyer" shows that ultimately there is no caste. Why is there no caste? Skin, flesh, blood, bone, marrow, fat, and semen: since these things are present in all, in brahmins, in

caṇḍālas (outcastes), and the rest, it is shown that there is no caste.

On the passage beginning "Not kept secret": when someone without the pledges (samaya) learns of it, he thinks ill of the bodhisattva and thereby goes to hell. Since the bodhisattva has made the aspiration to benefit all sentient beings, he would then fall away from it.

"Vajra" means Vairocana, Akṣobhya, Ratnasambhava, Amitābha, and Amoghasiddhi, whose nature is the five kinds of gnosis; these are called the five families. These words teach the following meaning. Whatever woman one finds, the mother and the rest, one should bless her with the five families, contemplate the nature of all phenomena just as it is, and engage in the practice, thinking of it as making offerings to all the Tathāgatas. One should think of giving to all sentient beings such a samādhi, the stage of meditating on such method and wisdom. Throughout what has just been explained, the yogin should apply diligent effort in order to understand reality.

"Six families are taught, each in its own kind" means that, with Vajradhara, they are six. Who is Vajradhara? He sends forth manifold emanations and, throughout the immeasurable realm of sentient beings, tames all sentient beings with the cloud of Dharma. Abiding on the ten grounds, he is the cause of the perfectly complete buddha. Therefore he is called the father of all the Tathāgatas. In the vehicle of Secret Mantra, what is generated through the stages of the fivefold full awakening is called Vajrasattva. What is generated from its transformation is called the perfectly complete buddha.

Form would have no resistance; there would be no past, no present, and no further birth; white and black karma would have no object; there would be no relationship of master and disciple; and even the effort of those who wish to accomplish awakening would become pointless. To dispel these faults, the Tathāgata teaches. As for the passage beginning "Mantras and deities truly abide": conceptual thought of one, many, and the like is called elaboration. Free of that, everything exists. Therefore it is called "the nature free of elaboration." What is it that is called "the nature free of elaboration"? It is what one understands oneself but cannot express to others. It is of an exceedingly luminous nature. Conventionally, it is shown in the names and forms of Vairocana and the rest. To sentient beings it shows whatever each is devoted to. Wisdom and the rest are spoken of conventionally.

On the passage beginning "From the father, natural bliss is obtained": in the state of Vajrasattva, he attains the samādhi of nondual gnosis, the nature of

all phenomena, and experiences bliss free of afflictions; then, having abandoned all habitual tendencies, he becomes a Tathāgata. He thereby comes to enjoy his own bliss. These words teach this meaning: having abandoned the habitual tendencies of pleasure, pain, and the like, the Tathāgata is shown not to be inert by nature. What kind of Tathāgata is he? One who has found the nature of great bliss, born of samādhi, free of afflictions, uninterrupted, and so forth. What is the samādhi of the Tathāgata like? On the passage beginning "That which has died through bliss": because bliss is found through the samādhi of the Tathāgata, worldly bliss, which is accompanied by afflictions, dies. How does it die? It ceases and does not arise again afterward. The samādhi of the Tathāgata is of the nature of bliss.

The commentary on the fifth chapter of the Hevajra, composed by Padmāṅkuravajra, is complete.

What is called "conduct" (caryā)? Going about in secret is called conduct. Enjoying the five sense pleasures as a cause of understanding is also called conduct. On the passage beginning "By which reality is known": what has become directly perceived is called "known." The nature of Heruka is called "reality." By what is it made directly perceived? By this conduct that is to be explained. "Accomplished" means that the body of Heruka has come to ripen. By what cause does the body of Heruka ripen? By the perfections.

"A lone tree": a tree where the retinue of Dhanada (Kubera) and others dwell is called a lone tree. "A charnel ground": a place where corpses lie is called a charnel ground. "At night" is the time when people sleep. "A house of the mātṛkās" means a house of the mother goddesses located in a village. "Or a solitary place" means away from people. "The village outskirts" means where the sounds of the town are not heard. Alternatively, one's own aggregates, together with the limbs such as the hands, are called "the lone tree." Because these same aggregates are accompanied by breath, they are called "the charnel ground." "Mātṛkās" are the elements. "House" is their coming together. "Night" is desire and the rest. "Solitary place" is being free of worldly conceptual thought. "The village outskirts" is the nearby maṇḍala.

The yogin of approach, the intermediate one, the one greater than that, and the one still far greater than that: these are the four kinds of yogins. In them, in order, four lights of gnosis arise: the arising of the heat of gnosis, the arising of forbearance through that heat, the emergence of light rays from the crown of the head, and the genuine dharma.

On the passage beginning "By one endowed with some slight power": if a yogin who, through worldly heat, has gained a slight mastery of gnosis wishes to undertake the conduct, it is by this, which the Tathāgata has taught. By what means? The passage beginning "An excellent woman, wide-eyed." Why is that the means? The light of gnosis is delicate, the senses waver, and the winds of the sense objects are strong; since for such reasons gnosis would cease, by performing this conduct gnosis does not cease.

Alternatively, the words of the passage beginning "Delighting in singing songs" teach the purity of song and dance.

On the passage beginning "The fire offering and the sacrifice": it teaches the qualities of a yogin who has found world-transcending heat. Through the power of keen wisdom and through samādhi, he is capable of everything. Therefore it is shown that the world-transcending yogin is greater than the worldly yogin. Hence:

Freed from pledges and vows,
endowed with true yoga,
one should practice the conduct of yoga.

The commentary on the sixth chapter of the Hevajra, composed by Padmāṅkuravajra, is complete.

"Of signs" is a word from the language of the caṇḍālas. Or else it means "designated." "Sign" (mudrā): the gesture by which a signal is first shown is called the "sign." "With the answering sign": the gesture by which a signal is shown afterward is called "with the answering sign." These words teach this meaning. When a yogin's mind has become stable in samādhi, it has become stable through the force of habituation to meritorious deeds. Buddhas and bodhisattvas meet with that yogin, teach him the Dharma, and also show him signs. In what form do they show them? In the form of yoginīs and the like. The words "Or else the garland gesture is shown" teach that yogin and yoginī meet in person. The words "Having bestowed the garland" teach a sign.

"Outside" means a place that is not the domain of those without the pledges. "Gathering" means the gathering of the yoginīs. What do the gathered yoginīs do? Wherever there is a yogin endowed with meritorious deeds, they bestow on him a garland of flowers. Then, having summoned the yogin, they say, "Abide in our pledges!" And the yogin replies in this way. "As the yoginīs have spoken, so must everything be done" means that he says, "At all times I shall do whatever the yoginīs say."

For the sake of yogins who delight in outer places, the twelve, the seats and the rest, are taught. By what words are the twelve taught? They are taught by the passage beginning "The seat and the secondary seat" (pīṭha and upapīṭha). I shall explain the chief abodes of the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

"These are the twelve grounds" means: the ground of conduct by aspiration, with the thought "I shall bring all sentient beings to buddhahood"; the first ground, Very Joyful; the second ground, Stainless; the third ground, Luminous; the fourth ground, Radiant; the fifth ground, Hard to Conquer; the sixth ground, Manifest; the seventh ground, Gone Far; the eighth ground, Immovable; the ninth ground, Excellent Intelligence; the tenth ground, Cloud of Dharma; and the eleventh, the ground of Universal Goodness (Samantabhadra). These are the twelve.

The arising of samādhi, the cultivation of dhāraṇīs, knowing the Dharma, knowing the meaning, knowing the Prakrit language, and knowing what others ask without needing to reflect: the cultivation of these is called the ground of conduct by aspiration, with the thought "I shall bring all sentient beings to buddhahood."

Because one rejoices in now knowing reality, having not known reality before, the first ground is called Very Joyful. On that ground, moreover, one works for the benefit of others just as one works for one's own benefit. The perfection of generosity also increases. Having understood reality, the bodhisattva should remain on that ground as long as he is unable to withstand the arising of even the slightest trace of the side of evil. When he is able to withstand it, he should enter the second, Stainless.

Having entered it, he becomes free of all the faults of sentient beings. The perfection of moral discipline also increases. Because it is free of the stain of immorality, the second ground is called Stainless. The bodhisattva abiding on that ground should remain there as long as he has not found worldly samādhi and is unable to retain the meaning of what he hears.

Having entered that ground, he works for the benefit of beings and bears suffering patiently. Therefore the perfection of patience increases. Because by the power of samādhi it illuminates countless world systems with light, the third is called Luminous. Even after finding worldly samādhi, the bodhisattva abiding on that ground should remain on the ground just explained as long as he is unable to teach the assembly, including the factors of awakening, and as long as he is unable to abandon all stinginess. When at some point he

becomes able, he should enter the fourth, Radiant.

In order to abandon the conceptual thoughts of the mind, the bodhisattva abiding there never forsakes the factors of awakening. His perfection of diligence expands. The bodhisattva abiding there is endowed with the power to burn the firewood of the afflictions, and it is called Radiant, with the light of the factors of awakening. The bodhisattva abiding there, meditating on the four noble truths, should remain on the ground just explained as long as his mind does not turn back from saṃsāra and as long as he does not cultivate the factors of awakening together with skillful means. When he is able to do so, he should enter the fifth.

The bodhisattva abiding there does not abandon the cultivation of the factors of awakening together with skillful means even when it becomes extremely painful, and none of the māras can conquer him; therefore the fifth ground is called Hard to Conquer. Because the bodhisattva abiding there constantly remains in meditation, his perfection of meditative concentration expands. Having abandoned bad habitual tendencies, the bodhisattva should remain on that ground as long as he has not found the cause of good habitual tendencies. When he has found it, he should enter the sixth, Manifest.

Because the bodhisattva abiding there constantly meditates on things as arising from the coming together of causes and conditions, his perfection of wisdom expands.

Because all the dharmas of all the Tathāgatas have become manifest, the sixth ground is called Manifest. He should remain on that ground as long as he does not know the cause of all phenomena. When he has come to know it, he should enter the seventh ground, Gone Far.

Because the bodhisattva abiding there, having come to know all causes, does not abandon them, his perfection of skillful means expands. Because he has gone far by entering the path of skillful means, the seventh ground is called Gone Far. He should remain there, however long that may be, as long as he has not found how to act for the benefit of sentient beings without a cause. When he has found it, he should enter the eighth ground, Immovable.

Because the bodhisattva abiding there obtains every accumulation of merit without exertion, and because he works for the benefit of all sentient beings without affliction, his perfection of aspiration expands. There is no cause, no exertion, and no discarding; because these are absent, the eighth ground is called Immovable. The bodhisattva abiding there should remain on the ground

just described as long as he is unable to teach individually the Dharma that the Tathāgata taught in the Prakrit language and so forth. When he becomes able to teach it, he should enter the ninth ground, Excellent Intelligence.

Because the power of wisdom of the bodhisattva abiding there is great, his perfection of power expands. Because he is able to teach the Dharma by way of every path, is without conditions, and has found what is superior, the ninth ground is called Excellent Intelligence. The bodhisattva abiding there should remain there as long as he is unable to emanate many fields of the Tathāgatas, unable to emanate many retinues, unable to send forth countless emanations and the like, and unable to bring the accumulations of merit of sentient beings to maturity. When he becomes able, he should enter the tenth ground, Cloud of Dharma.

Because the bodhisattva abiding there makes emanations, brings sentient beings to maturity, and gives to sentient beings all-pervasively through primordial wisdom, his perfection of primordial wisdom expands. Because from the cloud of proclaiming the Dharma he sends down a rain of Dharma upon immeasurable realms of sentient beings, the tenth ground is called Cloud of Dharma. The bodhisattva abiding there should remain on that ground until he has become unimpeded in the dhāraṇīs and until others can no longer obscure his primordial wisdom. When they can no longer do so, he should enter the eleventh ground, the buddha ground Samantabhadra. If even the Tathāgata cannot express the qualities of a mere portion of that ground, what need is there to speak of the qualities of the whole? That ground is called the gathering place of the buddhas and bodhisattvas. It is said to abide permanently.

"Lord of the ten grounds" means Vajrasattva. "Protector" means the body of Heruka. "Not other" means that it is not taught by way of the outer Jālandhara and so forth.

Next the day of the yoginīs' gathering is to be taught; therefore it says, "In the fortnight of the hungry ghosts." This means the waning fortnight of the month. Or else it is called the secret fortnight. Why is it called the secret fortnight? Because it is not the domain of the śrāvakas and the like. "Fourteenth" means the ground of the Tathāgata. "Eighth" means the eighth ground, Immovable.

Now what is to be eaten at that gathering is to be taught. "Banner" means a great field (a human corpse) hanging from a tree. "Struck by a weapon" means one killed by being struck with a sword or the like. As for "seven-times-born,"

one who has been born as a human for seven lives and has died a natural death is called seven-times-born.

On the passage beginning "By earnestly generating compassion": this concerns those who harm the Three Jewels and the like, and those who break the sacred commitments (samaya). Generating great compassion toward them, one should liberate their consciousness into the world-realm of Sukhāvatī, or else into any other good abode whatsoever. Having killed them by the sequence of closing, opening, and so forth, one should eat their flesh by the sequence of making it blaze, warming it, and so forth.

On the passage beginning "To whatever people": the being described before, who was liberated into the abode of Sukhāvatī, will, having heard the Dharma, say, "So-and-so has been kind to me." That being comes under the yogin's power. Those words teach that meaning. Furthermore, it teaches three things for the yogin to eat: one killed by another, one who has died naturally, and one killed by oneself with a good intention.

This completes the commentary on the seventh chapter of the Hevajra Tantra, composed by Padmāṅkuravajra.

On the passage beginning "the element of space": first, the vajra ground, the vajra fence, and the vajra cage are taught. In its center one should visualize the protection wheel. How should it be visualized? One imagines a ten-spoked wheel, yellow in color, revolving. Those words teach the wheel.

On the passage beginning "First, as is fitting": on that wheel, beginning from the east, one should set out the deities, Yamāntaka and the rest, according to their generation as given elsewhere. There, on the eastern spoke, is Yamāntaka, black in color, his right face white and his left red. His two right hands hold a vajra hammer and, in the last, a sword; his two left hands hold a jewel and, in the last, a lotus. On the southern spoke is Prajñāntaka, white in body color, his right face blue and his left red. His two right hands hold a white staff and a sword, and his two left a jewel and a lotus. On the western spoke is Padmāntaka, red in body color, his right face blue and his left white. His two right hands hold a lotus and a sword, and his two left a jewel and a wheel. On the northern spoke is Vighnāntaka, black in body color, his right face white and his left red. His two right hands hold a vajra and a sword, and his two left a jewel and a lotus. In the fire quarter (the southeast) is the great wrathful one Ṭakkirāja, graceful in manner, blue in body color, his right face white and his left red. His two right hands hold a hook and a sword, and his two left a jewel

and a lotus. In the rākṣasa quarter (the southwest) is Nīladaṇḍa; apart from his hand emblem, a blue staff, in all other respects he accords with Yamāntaka.

In the wind quarter (the northwest) is Mahābala; apart from his hand emblem, a trident, in all other respects he accords with Yamāntaka. Apart from Ṭakkirāja, all of these are short in body, with large, pendulous bellies, their bodies adorned with snakes. Their faces are of terrifying form, their tongues curled round, and they laugh with bared fangs. Their reddish-yellow hair swirls upward, and they have reddish-yellow beards. In the quarter of Īśāna (the northeast) is Acalanātha; apart from his hand emblem, a vajra, and his reddish-yellow eyes, in all else he accords with Ṭakkirāja. Above is Uṣṇīṣacakravartin, yellow in body color, his right face blue and his left white. His two right hands hold a yellow wheel and a sword, and his two left a jewel and a lotus. In the direction below is Sumbha; apart from his hand emblem, a vajra, in all else he is said to accord with Ṭakkirāja. All the wrathful ones embrace their consorts with their first hands.

The center of that wheel is what is called "the element of space." "Bhaga" means the source of phenomena (dharmodaya). It should be visualized right there, in the place just described. What is that source of phenomena like? It is a triangle, white in color, with its narrow point facing downward. "As is fitting" means in due order. The order is the earth maṇḍala, the water maṇḍala, the fire maṇḍala, and the great wind maṇḍala. In its center one should visualize the wheel. What is the meaning of "one should visualize the wheel"? It means that, transforming Vairocana, one generates the celestial palace. "Two-tiered" means that the celestial palace has two tiers. "At the core it becomes one" means that the pericarp of the lotus at the center of the celestial palace is called the first tier. "In the triangle, the other is taught" means that, apart from the pericarp, as much of the body of the palace as lies within the source of phenomena is called the second tier. "Wheel" means that the deities are to be meditated on. "In its center" means the center of the celestial palace. "Corpses are to be visualized" means that one should visualize great fields as the seats of the fifteen deities. Where are they to be visualized? They are to be visualized on the pericarp, on the eight petals, at the four gates, at the tip of the eastern lotus petal, and at the tip of the western lotus petal.

"On top of that" means on top of whatever lies upon the principal place. "It becomes a moon" means that one should visualize a moon arising from the melting of a and the rest. "Then it is wholly pressed down by the sun" means that one should visualize a sun disk arising from the melting of ka and the rest.

"The seed upon it" means aṃ and hūṃ. From the transformation of all of these, one should visualize Vajrasattva. What is Vajrasattva like? "Faces and hand emblems like the son's" is explained to mean that he accords with the resultant form. If one asks, "If he accords with the form, faces, and so forth of the deity that has become the result, what difference is there?", that difference is to be shown; therefore it says, "Like a moonstone gem in color." Those words show this difference: the seat of the causal form is a moon disk; its body is like the moon in color; and its rays of light too are shown to be like the moon's rays. The resultant form has a sun seat and the rays of the sun.

On the passage beginning "The body arisen from the letters": "arisen from the letters" refers to the body of Vajrasattva. When that body is in union, one should not visualize the hūṃ phaṭ that immobilizes the bodhicitta. Because that is not to be visualized, it says, "Moon and sun united without duality." That is the coming together of the two, the bodhicitta and the self-arisen flower.

"Gaurī and the rest" teaches the emanation from what has just been described. Who are Gaurī and the rest? They are the maṇḍala deities of the Eight-Faced One (Hevajra) and the others. Its meaning is to be explained in detail: because Gaurī and the rest are born from the union of sun and moon, it says, "Through the nature of method and wisdom," and so forth. The union of method and wisdom is what is called "from the differentiation of moon and sun." As for the passage beginning "Their body colors are differentiated individually," their individual distinctions are to be understood in relation to the principal deity in the center. The definition of the words "Gaurī and the rest" is to be understood as the result in which a likeness of Nairātmyā and the others arises.

In order to attain the result of maturation, the sense sources such as the eye are to be blessed; therefore it says, "First, one should visualize the black one," and so forth. The line "Or else, likewise, at the end of passionlessness" teaches the blessing of the four cakras and the result of personal effort.

In order to abandon all that is mistaken and to generate what is unmistaken, the generation stage is to be explained. What is the generation stage like? It says, "Just as with the generation stage." This teaches that it is practiced conventionally, with respect to things of cause and result. "Likewise with the completion stage" means abiding as complete and as established by its own nature.

"At the end of all is innate joy" means that nonconceptual primordial wisdom alone is the cause, and it does not depend on the others. That is called innate joy. "The joy of supreme bliss is said to be existence" means that wisdom accompanied by passion is called the joy of supreme bliss, and that is what is taught as existence. The wisdom free from passion, like a lamp that has gone out, is nirvāṇa, and it is called passionlessness, the passing beyond all. Abiding in equanimity is called the intermediate, mere joy. What is free from those three is called "The innate is devoid of these." That teaches innate joy.

If innate joy is what is free from those three, namely saṃsāra, nirvāṇa, and equanimity, and it would be right to set those three aside and express it with some other word, why is innate joy taught in relation to those three? In answer to that it says, "The innate cannot be taught by another; it is not obtained anywhere." That is, it is not taught by anything other than words such as "saṃsāra." The innate is not obtained from anything other than saṃsāra and the like.

If one asks why it is not obtained from anything else: that which is not a good quality is saṃsāra, and that, moreover, is not distinct from consciousness. And consciousness has no past or future in it; it exists in the nature of an instant of extreme subtlety. Therefore, who is it that cycles? What is it that is called cycling, saṃsāra? What is the act of cycling? There is no such thing; therefore saṃsāra is shown to be nonexistent. Therefore nirvāṇa, too, does not exist. Since those two do not exist, the intermediate, too, is not found. Therefore understanding the very nature of saṃsāra and the rest is called innate joy. That is why it is taught that it cannot be expressed by any other word, and that it is not obtained from anything else.

How does one come to understand such primordial wisdom? Therefore, on the passage beginning "Through honoring and serving the guru": by the power of habituation to meritorious action, the mind becomes good, and so one meets a genuine guru, and he teaches the path. By the power of habituation to that, one comes to understand it oneself. In the instant that primordial wisdom free from obscurations arises, one understands all aspects. For that reason, all aspects are one. Therefore it is taught that everything arises from innate joy. Such primordial wisdom arises through constant habituation. To make that understood, these words are given: it teaches the passage beginning "The yogin who has contemplated in this way."

The passage beginning "Grass, trees, creepers, and the rest" means that these are aspects of consciousness, and not of anything else. If all aspects do not exist apart from consciousness, why do outsiders not know this? In answer: because for immeasurable ages they have imagined them to be external, they do not understand.

The yogin who is habituated to the equal taste accomplishes all activities. How does he accomplish them? To show that, these words are given: "Action arises through conception." This means that the yogin abiding in the samādhi of innate joy accomplishes all activities for the benefit of sentient beings just as he conceives them. Here "action" means the activities of pacifying and so forth. All aspects, all conceptions, and all actions: all of these are accomplished by the yogin just described. Therefore these words are given: it teaches the passage beginning "He himself withdraws, he himself creates."

"Primordial wisdom arisen from the source of phenomena" means the primordial wisdom born from the union of vajra and lotus. "Endowed with method" means endowed with deity yoga. That teaches the cause that gives rise to primordial wisdom. Furthermore, the causes of the arising of primordial wisdom are the stirring, not giving up the camphor, and the power of meditation. What kind of primordial wisdom arises through their force? It is free from all conceptual elaboration; free from both past and future; known by oneself; impossible to express in words to another; able to make all objects directly evident; not inert, and all-knowing; the primordial wisdom of past, future, and present. It is the innate nature just described.

This completes the commentary on the eighth chapter of the Hevajra Tantra, composed by Padmāṅkuravajra.

"The six faculties" means the eye faculty and the rest. "The five aggregates" means the aggregate of form and the rest. Of these, the sense faculties, the five objects, what was taught before beginning with "two kinds of form," the four great elements, the supports of the eye faculty and the rest, and past form and so on, are called the aggregate of form. "The aggregate of feeling" is pleasure, suffering, and equanimity. Furthermore, the eighteen feelings arising from eye contact and the rest, and the countless feelings, past and so on, are called the aggregate of feeling. As for "perception," grasping at signs through the coming together of causes and conditions is called perception. Its causes are the countless forms and so on. It is, moreover, small, great, and immeasurable. That too, whether past, present, or future, is called the

aggregate of perception. "The aggregate of formations" is whatever arises from the mind. Here "what arises from the mind" means faith and the like, and attachment and the like; these too arise in dependence on the eye faculty and the rest. All of these are called the aggregate of formations. "The aggregate of consciousness" is the six, eye consciousness and the rest. These are virtuous and nonvirtuous, determinate and indeterminate. They are small, middling, and great. These are called the aggregate of consciousness. The six inner bases and the six outer objects. Their purity is taught as being free from apprehended and apprehender. This is taught by the passage beginning "Vajrā, transformed in the aggregate of form."

Having taught the purity of the deities, the purity of the principal deity in the center, the Eight-Faced One (Hevajra), is to be taught. To teach it, on the line "The arms are the emptinesses": the emptiness of the inner, the emptiness of the outer, the emptiness of the outer and inner, the emptiness of emptiness, the emptiness of the great, the emptiness of the ultimate, the emptiness of the conditioned, the emptiness of the unconditioned, utter emptiness, the emptiness of what has neither beginning nor end, the emptiness of what is not discarded, the emptiness of intrinsic nature, the emptiness of all phenomena, the emptiness of own characteristics, the emptiness of nonapprehension, and the emptiness of essential nature. Of these, as for "the emptiness of the inner," the eye faculty and the rest are called the emptiness of the inner. Form, the object of the eye, and the rest are called the emptiness of the outer. Because the mind that thinks "those two are empty" is itself also empty, it is called the emptiness of the outer and inner. As for "the emptiness of emptiness," because the mind that thinks "all phenomena are emptiness" is itself also emptiness, it is called the emptiness of emptiness. The emptiness of the east and the other directions is called the emptiness of the great.

As for "the emptiness of the ultimate": because nirvāṇa, too, is empty, it is called the emptiness of the ultimate. "The emptiness of the conditioned" refers to the desire realm, the form realm, and the formless realm; these are called the emptiness of the conditioned. As for "the emptiness of the unconditioned": what is without arising, abiding, and ceasing is called the emptiness of the unconditioned. As for "utter emptiness": being empty of those two, the view of permanence and the view of annihilation, is called utter emptiness. "The emptiness of what has neither beginning nor end" means the absence of going and coming; that is called the emptiness of what has neither beginning nor end. As for "the emptiness of what is not discarded": because nothing is

discarded, it is called the emptiness of what is not discarded. As for "the emptiness of intrinsic nature": because the intrinsic nature of all phenomena was not made by anyone at all, it is called the emptiness of intrinsic nature. As for "the emptiness of all phenomena": being empty of those two, the conditioned and the unconditioned, is called the emptiness of all phenomena. As for "the emptiness of own characteristics": because all phenomena are empty of their own individual characteristics, it is called the emptiness of own characteristics. As for "the emptiness of nonapprehension": the nonapprehension of the phenomena of the three times is called the emptiness of nonapprehension. As for "the emptiness of essential nature": because whatever is born from causes and conditions does not exist ultimately, it is called the emptiness of essential nature. Their purity is the sixteen arms.

"All the feet, by the purity of the māras" means crushing the māra of the afflictions and the rest. How are they crushed? By the power of wisdom. That wisdom, moreover, is fourfold: the emptiness of entities, the emptiness of non-entities, the emptiness of intrinsic nature, and the emptiness of the other by its nature. Of these, "the emptiness of entities" means that entities are empty of their own intrinsic nature. "The emptiness of non-entities" is so called because it is empty through the absence of entities. "The emptiness of intrinsic nature" means being empty by intrinsic nature. As for "the emptiness of the other by its nature": because the other itself is empty by its nature, it is called the emptiness of the other by its nature. Their purity is taught as the four feet.

"The faces, of the eight liberations" refers to these: one with form looking at forms; having directly realized with the body the liberation of the beautiful, abiding after training in the conduct of one gone forth; abiding in the sphere of infinite consciousness; abiding in the thought, "Space is infinite"; abiding in the sphere of nothingness; abiding in neither perception nor non-perception; and the absorption of cessation. Their purity is the eight faces.

"The eyes, of the threefold vajra" means that the purity of body, speech, and mind is the three eyes. "By whatever the world is bound" means that cognition bound by the darkness of this or that conceptual thought is freed by itself, through the light of that very cognition.

This completes the commentary on the ninth chapter of the Hevajra Tantra, composed by Padmāṅkuravajra.

"In the house of a bodhisattva" means a charnel ground. "Or else, take any one there" means that accomplishment is obtained through the cause of method and wisdom; in this, family is not the criterion. "The face covering of the consort (mudrā)" will be taught on the occasion of explaining the four empowerments.

The nature of innate joy has already been taught in the chapter on the gathering of the great yoginīs. Here it is taught so that the disciple may understand it; therefore it is not the fault of repetition. The passage beginning "Or else, devoid of them all" means that passion and passionlessness are imagined by mistaken conceptual thought. When that conceptual thought has ceased, they too cease. With those two ceased, the intermediate is not found either. Therefore innate joy is devoid of those three. Or else, the innate just described is to be understood. How is it to be understood? It is understood by oneself as free from all elaboration, and it cannot be expressed to another. Apart from that, innate joy is not found anywhere else. Therefore innate joy is the very nature of the three joys. "In the bliss of supreme play" means the nonconceptual samādhi. By finding it, one becomes free from the conceptual thoughts of the apprehended and the rest. "The twofold innate" means that innate joy is called twofold through the division into method and wisdom. The innate is the perfectly and completely awakened Buddha.

"Emptiness" means the nonapprehension of all phenomena. "Compassion" means freeing all sentient beings from saṃsāra; moreover, that whose nature is to free them while taking them as its object is called compassion. If one asks how emptiness, which has no object, and compassion, which has an object, can become one, there is no fault in that. Whatever samādhi is accompanied by emptiness is called emptiness, and it is of the nature of light. Compassion is of the nature of the eye of wisdom. Therefore, when light has arisen in samādhi and one looks with the eye of compassion, one comes to know by what means each sentient being will be freed, and so one works for the benefit of sentient beings. Therefore emptiness and compassion are not incompatible. Hence the two become a benefit to each other.

This completes the commentary on the tenth chapter of the Hevajra Tantra, composed by Padmāṅkuravajra.

"The gaze resting on the left, for control" means that one should look to the left with both eyeballs. That is called the gaze for bringing under control. In the same manner, looking to the right, one should make the gaze for summoning.

That is called the gaze for summoning. The passage beginning "Both eyeballs upward" means that, moving both eyeballs to the left, one looks slightly upward. That is called the immobilizing gaze. "Between, on the bridge of the nose" means that, setting both eyeballs between the eyes, one looks at the tip of the nose. That is called the killing gaze.

"One should not entertain this thought" means one should not doubt. Why should one not doubt? Because it arises from valid cognition. What is called valid cognition? Whatever has been cultivated and has become manifest is called valid cognition. Therefore it says, "The miraculous power of the buddhas is inconceivable." Here "inconceivable" means without conceptual thought. What is that which is without conceptual thought? In immeasurable world-realms it displays immeasurable miracles, such as immeasurable saṃsāra and nirvāṇa. If all of these too can be accomplished by the yogin, what need is there to mention that a mere gaze can be accomplished? "There is no need to kill here" teaches the commitment to be guarded. The passage beginning "First nā, and first ga" teaches the commitment to be eaten.

This completes the commentary composed by Padmāṅkuravajra on the King of Sections of Vajragarbha's Utterly Unsurpassed Awakening, from the Hevajra Tantra.

"Having contemplated, one should purify the image" means this: having generated the deity and the rest through the sequence of the five awakenings, one should imagine what has been generated melting. Then, urging it, one should imagine it rising up. One should visualize the blessing of its sense sources, and the wisdom being (jñānasattva). These should be completed through samādhi. Then one should imagine that the Tathāgatas confer empowerment on it and that its head is adorned by the lord of the family.

Having visualized these, one should pour into the victory vase and the other vases the medicines of the five essences, the five kinds of nectar, and fragrant water. Their mouths should be adorned with twigs of palāśa and other trees, their necks tied with clean cloth, and the deities' hand emblems drawn well upon them. Then, on top of the victory vase and the others, one ties a flower garland to a vajra, and holding the end of the flower garland, one should offer the approach recitation. For this, one should offer the mantras of one's own chosen deity and the others. Next come the five products of the cow, the five barks, the five fragrances, and sesame oil.

Then the bathing is to be taught: making offerings with countless songs and the sounds of drums, one should bathe the painted image and the like in a mirror. Then the ransom should be sent out; then the summoning and so forth should be done and garments and the like offered, and these should be offered in order with their mantras. In addition, one should make the offering of samādhi and the praise, and taste the nectar.

This completes the commentary composed by Padmāṅkuravajra on the first chapter of the second part of the Hevajra Tantra, which sets out the stages of installation.

First, it teaches that one should constantly cultivate it. In all four modes of deportment one should keep it in mind. Therefore it is taught by the line "Not for an instant does he think of anything else." Earlier, the purification of wisdom was taught for the sake of performing yogic conduct. Now, to accomplish the siddhi of the Great Seal (mahāmudrā), these words are given: it states the passage beginning "Having attained that very thing, O wide-eyed one." Earlier, innate joy was taught in its various aspects. Now, innate joy alone is the body of all aspects, and it is itself the Tathāgata. Through division it becomes fivefold, and when that is divided in full it becomes countless, as numerous as the sands of the Ganges. To make that meaning understood, it is taught by the passage beginning "Great joy is one alone."

This completes the commentary composed by Padmāṅkuravajra on the second chapter of the Hevajra Tantra, called Conception, set out in stages.

Because, having drawn one out of an inferior lineage, it restrains one from the ground of the śrāvakas and the like, it is called restraint (saṃvara). Where does that restraint abide? For that reason it says, "It abides firmly in e vaṃ." Here e vaṃ means the source of phenomena. The restraint just described is of the nature of great bliss. It is understood through its method. "The joys arise from it" means that the joys taught earlier are born from it. "By the division of the moments" refers to the diverse and the rest. These four are to be correlated with the four empowerments: the master empowerment, the secret empowerment, the wisdom-gnosis empowerment, and the fourth empowerment.

In order for the disciple first to make his request to the master, he should recite these words:

Just as Bodhivajra gave
The great of the great to the buddhas,

So now, in order to protect me,
Bodhivajra, give it to me.

Then one should imagine that Buddhalocanā and the others, holding vases, confer the empowerment. After that the verse should be recited. The verse is this:

The empowerment of the great vajra,
To which the three realms pay homage,
I shall give, as to all the buddhas;
It arises from the abode of the three secrets.

Having recited the verse in this way, one takes up, in the hand that holds the vajra, water charged with the mantra of Amṛtakuṇḍalin, and, imagining the disciple to be like a universal monarch, one should sprinkle it. Then, imagining a crown made of gold or the like as the chosen deity, and holding the crown on the disciple's head as taught before, one should visualize all the Tathāgatas in the sky and imagine them entering the crown in the form of a crown. In this way one should confer the crown empowerment. Then, holding the vajra, one says:

Today the empowerment is conferred on you,
The vajra holder's empowerment, by the buddhas.
This belongs to all the buddhas;
Hold this vajra for the sake of accomplishment.

Then, holding the vajra, one touches it to the disciple's head, throat, and heart, and afterwards one should give it into his right hand. Then one should give the bell into his left hand. The disciple, holding both, should make the embrace. Then one should recite the verse, saying, "oṃ vajra adhipati tiṣṭha abhiṣiñcāmi tiṣṭha samaya vajra stvaṃ." After that, holding the vajra and bell on the disciple's head, one says, "oṃ vajra satva stvaṃ abhiṣiñcāmi vajra nāma abhiṣekata, O glorious so-and-so Vajra!" This teaches the name empowerment. Then there are the vajra commitment, the bell commitment, and the commitment of the Great Seal; one should give these three commitments. Then one should explain the reality of the maṇḍala. Then one should give the prophecy.

Then one should give the vajra going-forth. Then one should give the encouragement. These are called the master empowerment.

Having made the place secluded with curtains and the like, the disciple should offer to the master, for the sake of the secret empowerment, his own beloved, who is endowed with compassion and the rest and endowed with the three samādhis. Having offered her, he should recite the verse that begins "Bodhivajra."

If one asks what the guru does: he should stimulate the lotus of the Dharma-Nature (the consort), and then he should fix his mind within the vajra-jewel. He does not let it move along the path of the space element. Turning it back from the lotus, he holds it fast between the thumb and the ring finger, and, making sure that it does not become an object of the disciple's view, he should place it into the space within his lotus-like mouth. Then the disciple should speak thus: having said "aho sukhaṃ," he should draw it in and generate perfect enjoyment. Then the Dharma-Nature should rise, take the essence of the flower that abides in her own body, and place it into the disciple's lotus-like mouth. She, moreover, is unclothed. This is called the secret empowerment.

According to the view of those who hold that the Dharma-Nature who has become awakened is one and the same, that very one should be given for the wisdom-gnosis empowerment. According to the view of those who do not hold the Nature to be one and the same, another Emptiness (likewise a consort) should be given.

Then, in order to bring into direct perception the gnosis that has been heard of and understood, the disciple should urge the master with the verse of exhortation taught earlier. Then the master gives the Emptiness into the disciple's hand, and, holding her with his own hand, he should recite this verse:

This one is excellent as your consort.
What the buddhas have realized, you are to enjoy.
Through the yoga of the maṇḍala's stages,
Experience true bliss.
Do not purify by any other means;
The three worlds are pure by their intrinsic nature.
Therefore do not abandon wisdom;
In the three times, do not abandon it for an instant.
This is the unsurpassed going-forth of knowledge
Of all the buddhas.

One who rejects it or reviles it is declared a fool;
He will not attain the supreme accomplishment.

Having spoken thus, he should give her.

Then the Emptiness just described, having made herself unclothed, displays the source of phenomena (dharmodaya), and, assuming an amorous manner, speaks thus:

O, can you practice the commitment in this way?
Can you partake of Vairocana and the rest?
In blood, in bodhicitta, in the great flesh,
And in the Emptinesses, you must place your faith.
You must touch the bhaga lotuses.
Whatever is spoken of, embracing and the rest,
All of these you must perform.
O, by doing so, bliss will arise.

To this the disciple replies:

O goddess, why do you say that I cannot?
I will eat excrement, urine, and the rest.
I will always have faith in the Emptinesses.
I will touch the bhaga lotuses.

When the disciple has spoken thus, the Emptiness speaks:

aho! This lotus of mine
Is endowed with every bliss.
Whoever, possessing the master's instructions, enjoys it,
Before him I myself abide.
Just as it has been recited, so you must enjoy it.
You must worship the perfect buddhas and the rest.
Great bliss, the king, abides here.

Then this mantra of the Emptiness should be recited: bhaja stvaṃ ho.

The disciple, for his part, does as follows. Through the master's instructions he should come to understand the channel called Vajradhātvīśvarī, which lies on the left side of the flower; and afterward, when the lotus has blossomed, he should taste it, just as, for example, a bee tastes the nectar of a flower.

As long as the yogin does not die,
He does not abandon the bodhicitta.
All that the mind desires will be found.
Born in joy and ever abiding, what is it like?
If the bodhicitta should be abandoned,
That which is the treasury of all accomplishments,
With the consciousnesses and the aggregates in a swoon,
True accomplishments will not arise.
In the yoga of the space element and the vajra,
Through contact with the tangible, it is exceedingly great.
As bliss arises, Saṃvara (supreme bliss) brings delight;
Saṃvara is to be understood as the middle between passion and dispassion.
The space of the lotus is pressed by the jewel;
There, in its place, seated in the vajra posture,
One should know the mind to be in the vajra.
The gnosis that arises at that time
Cannot be expressed as "The gnosis is like this."
It is not passion, nor is it free from passion,
Nor can what is called "the middle" be apprehended.

These teach the wisdom-gnosis empowerment. The reality of the wisdom-gnosis empowerment just explained is called the precious empowerment. It is to be known through the master's instructions.

The reality of empowerment is just as has been recited.
The disciple's mind truly knows it for itself.
Since it is truly freed through the most profound vehicle,
The precious word empowerment should be taught.

These teach the fourth empowerment. Those four should be correlated with the four moments.

"Spoken by the Teacher" means "the guru teaches." "Consort" means the Emptiness. "Great bliss" means that what was just explained is itself great bliss, and is the essence of the joy of intrinsic nature. "Until awakening is attained" means that it extends all the way to the perfectly complete buddha. That is true gnosis. "All abide in the body" refers to the Dharma Body, the Body of Perfect Enjoyment, the Emanation Body, and the Body of Great Bliss: these have come to abide in it.

If one asks why great bliss is called a "body," I shall explain. Aspects such as blue do not exist anywhere separately, apart from consciousness. Therefore all are aspects of cognition; through the force of error they appear as distinct. Does it follow, then, that bliss and the like are not qualities? Leaving cognition aside, do they arise from some other cause? That is not so. Suffering and the like are not experienced as anything other than consciousness. Therefore aspects such as blue are not distinct from bliss, and bliss, too, is not distinct from blue and the like. Whatever is not distinct from something is that very thing, as, for example, when one says "sāla tree." That which is without activity is called an "entity."

That is why the passage beginning "Bliss is black, bliss" was taught above. By that reasoning, great bliss is taught to be the body of intrinsic nature (svābhāvikakāya).

If one asks how the awakening mind, remaining for as long as saṃsāra exists, works for the benefit of sentient beings, then, in order to show this, the passage beginning "Through the skillful means of the maṇḍala and the rest" was taught. Here "maṇḍala" means the stages of the celestial palace and so forth. Having completed the body of the deity, one should imagine a yellow phaṭ in the space of the two, the lotus of the consort who is one's own radiance and one's own vajra. This arrests the awakening mind. For one who constantly cultivates this in that way, accomplishment will be attained.

The aggregates, the elements, and the sense sources are neither true nor false. Since they are neither one nor many, they are not true. Since they are seen in direct perception, they are not false either. They are like, for example, the reflection of the moon in water. To show this, it is taught in the passage beginning "Likewise, it is not false, not true."

"Sleep should not be given up" means this: since through not sleeping a yogin's body becomes weak, meditative absorption is not achieved. Therefore one should sleep. "The wise one should not recite mantras" means that one should not recite mantras with the thought, 'This is the ultimate.' In the same way, one should not practice meditative absorption either. The passage beginning "One should neither bathe nor observe cleanliness" teaches the abandonment of the eight worldly observances. "Nor should the senses be restrained" means this: since one will not become free of the obscuration of the knowable without purifying the sense objects, one should purify the sense objects and should not restrain the senses. As long as one is not free of the

mind that accepts and rejects, one will not become free of the obscuration of the afflictions. Therefore one should eat everything. Its meaning is taught in the passage beginning "The five ambrosias, molasses, liquor."

Earlier, at the time of blessing the sense sources, the purity of the colors was taught. Now the goddesses who are the purity of aversion and the rest are to be taught, and so they are taught in the passage beginning "The eye is Mohavajrā (Vajrā of Delusion)." The words "It is a lapse from the sacred commitment (samaya)" teach that this is like killing buddhas and bodhisattvas.

This completes the commentary composed by Padmāṅkuravajra on the third chapter of the Hevajra Tantra, set out in sequence through symbolic language.

"Song" means the vajra song. The indivisibility of emptiness and compassion is called "vajra," and what makes it understood is called "song." Performing the yoga of the deity is called "vajra." If one asks why it is called "vajra," it is because it consists of the five wisdoms. Therefore it is called the "vajra dance." Whoever hears the song and sees the dance will obtain great merit. Through the power of that merit, and through having practiced the meditative absorption of the deity, great joy will arise from the yogin's singing and dancing. By its power, goddesses who have faith in the Buddha will come, and yogins who have previously gained accomplishment will come as well. The signs of their coming should be understood as they are given in the tantra.

"The awakening mind arises" means the nature of emptiness and compassion. Moreover, in its essence as cause and result, it is thirty-two. The passage beginning "maṇḍala" means this: having imagined the celestial palace and so forth, one should imagine the awakening mind abiding surrounded by the deities of the maṇḍala. The purity of all is one's very self, and the intrinsic nature of all entities is oneself. One should contemplate in this way. To show its meaning, it is taught with the words "Through the stage of self-blessing." "Ultimate" means working for the benefit of sentient beings without conceptual thought. "Conventional" means the bliss that is naturally experienced. The purity of these two is bliss and camphor.

Earlier, the consort (mudrā) was taught as belonging to the families of Vairocana and the rest. Here she is to be taught as having the nature of the five wisdoms; therefore it is taught in the passage beginning "She herself is the actual mirror-like wisdom." The passage beginning "Just as outwardly" means: just as the outer maṇḍala is, so is one's own body.

Tathāgatas such as Śākyamuni have a form through which they have accomplished the benefit of all sentient beings at one time, throughout the immeasurable realms of beings. Through that form they work for the benefit of sentient beings for as long as saṃsāra exists. That is called the emanation body (nirmāṇakāya). The Tathāgata has spoken of its meaning:

The body through which, in images of every kind,
The benefit of all sentient beings is accomplished,
And which, insubstantial, unceasingly accomplishes every aim:
A body such as this is called the emanation body.

The four applications of mindfulness and so on up to the noble eightfold path; the four immeasurables; the eight liberations; and the four meditative concentrations of the form realm, the four formless attainments, and the attainment of cessation, which make nine: these are called the causes of meditative absorption. Earth, water, fire, wind, blue, yellow, red, white, consciousness, and space: these are called the ten totality bases (kṛtsnāyatana). "Inwardly possessing form" refers to blue, yellow, red, and white: knowing these as free of conceptual thought. "Outwardly possessing form" refers to outer form, inner form, the mixture of the two, and the aspect of form. These eight are called the bases of wisdom. Uprooting the turmoil of the afflictions in the minds of others is called the meditative absorption that dispels turmoil. Being thoroughly free of the causes of saṃsāra, being liberated from the bonds of saṃsāra, dispelling doubts, and, having generated earnest effort, working for the benefit of beings for as long as saṃsāra exists: these are called the wisdom of aspiration.

There is the wisdom of the six superknowledges, and there are the four analytical knowledges. Basis, object, mind, and wisdom: these are called the four purities. Life, mind, requisites, action, birth, inclination, aspiration, emanation, wisdom, and Dharma: these are called the ten masteries. There are the ten powers of the Tathāgata, the four qualities of skill (vaiśāradya), and the three that need no guarding. Those who wish to listen when the Dharma is explained, those who do not wish to listen, and those who remain neutral: teaching the Dharma while regarding these three with equanimity is called the three mindfulnesses. Certainty about the time for working for the benefit of sentient beings is called never failing sentient beings. Having not even a trace of the seeds of the two obscurations is called freedom from the two obscurations. A kindly mind toward all sentient beings is called compassion. The qualities of the Tathāgata that others cannot take away are

eighteen. All of these are called the Dharma body (dharmakāya). Their meaning is to be shown in summary:

The factors of awakening, the immeasurables,
The eight liberations in their order,
The absorption endowed with nine members,
The totality bases,
The bases of wisdom, of eight kinds,
Dispelling turmoil, the wisdom of aspiration,
The six superknowledges, the perfect wisdoms,
The four purities in every aspect,
The masteries and the ten powers,
The four knowledges of skill, the three needing no guarding,
The three mindfulnesses, the unfailing,
Freedom from obscuration, great compassion for beings,
The eighteen that cannot be taken away:
All of these, gathered together,
Are omniscience, the Dharma body.

So it has been said.

It is enjoyed by bodhisattvas of the eighth ground, or else it is enjoyed by bodhisattvas who are lords of the tenth ground. If one asks what it is that is enjoyed: that which bears the thirty-two excellent major marks and has the nature of the eighty excellent minor marks is the abode of the complete enjoyment of the Great Vehicle. The Tathāgata has spoken of its meaning. If one asks how he spoke of it:

Having thus the thirty-two marks as its self,
It is the body called complete enjoyment;
Adorned with the light rays of the eighty minor marks,
It is the enjoyment of the Great Vehicle.

That is called the body of complete enjoyment (saṃbhogakāya).

Because of its cause, the intrinsic nature of the world-transcending expanse of reality (dharmadhātu), that which is in essence the wisdom of the four applications of mindfulness and the rest is without afflictions, free of adventitious stains, completely pure in every aspect, and empty by intrinsic nature. The nature of what is thus, in which no sign is found, is unborn, and is the knowing, or else the finding, of world-transcending wisdom. That which abides by intrinsic nature, without being made, is called the body of great

bliss. The Tathāgata has spoken of its meaning. If one asks how he spoke of it:

Having attained the purity of the qualities,
Free of affliction in every aspect,
The Tathāgata's body of intrinsic nature
Is the intrinsic nature of these.

That is called the body of great bliss.

"Therefore the cause" means established by intrinsic nature, or abiding as established by intrinsic nature. If all sentient beings are buddhas by intrinsic nature, then wishing to be a bodhisattva and wishing to be a buddha would be pointless. Having heard the words of the Tathāgata, the yoginī was overwhelmed and fainted. If one asks by which words this is shown: it is shown by the passage beginning "Then, in all the goddesses." To raise her from that faint, the passage beginning "Sentient beings are buddhas" was taught. Here, what has come adventitiously is one's own imagining; it has not come from anywhere else. One has made one's own mind stained by oneself. If one asks what is called "stain": it is the conceptual thought of grasped object and grasping subject. By being free of it, the habitual tendencies too are pulled out by the root. Because the habitual tendencies are pulled out by the root, all sentient beings are buddhas. Whoever knows it in this way will attain accomplishment.

The passage beginning "Outcaste" refers to caste, the six classes of beings, and modes of birth. These are not fixed.

After one has performed the yoga of Heruka, or else the yoga of Nairātmyā, from a blue yaṃ there arises a wind maṇḍala shaped like a bow and marked with a banner. Above it, from the transformation of a red raṃ, there arises a red triangular fire maṇḍala. One should imagine it marked on top with a raṃ, or else with a vajra. Above that, one should imagine a skull cup (kapāla) arising from the transformation of the syllable a. Inside it are the foods to be eaten, the five kinds of ambrosia, and the five bright lamps. Above them, one should imagine the seed syllables of the five Tathāgatas. Above these, on a moon maṇḍala arising from the transformation of oṃ, one should imagine a vajra arising from the transformation of hūṃ. Then, as the wind kindles the fire, one should imagine everything melting into the essence of ambrosia. Then one should take the ambrosias already accomplished beforehand and pour them into the ambrosia. After that, one should bless it with the mantra oṃ āḥ hūṃ. Then, emanating from any one of Gaurī and the others, one

invites the maṇḍala of intrinsic nature and imagines it in front. To it one should offer arghaṃ and the rest. Then one should dissolve it. Imagining a hūṃ on the tongues of the central lord and the others, one should imagine them becoming vajras. Then one should taste the blessed ambrosia.

After that, the secret is in the four intermediate directions, above, and below. In those places, in sequence, are Śakra (Indra), Yama, Varuṇa, Dhanada (Kubera), Agni, the Rākṣasa, Vāyu, the Great God Mahādeva (Śiva), Sūrya (the sun god), Candra (the moon god), Brahmā, Pṛthivī (the earth goddess), and King Vemacitrin (lord of the asuras). One should summon them, imagine them in their own places, and offer arghaṃ and the rest. Then, reciting the mantra beginning oṃ inda jama, one should please them. Then, as taught before, one should perform the purification, the bali offering, and so forth. When striking with the inner ritual dagger (kīla), one imagines them at the crown of the head, abiding in the protection wheel. Imagining the wrathful ones with their lower bodies like kīlas and their upper bodies in their own forms, one should strike with kīlas, in sequence, those imagined before. Or else one should strike them by means of Amṛtakuṇḍalin.

This completes the commentary composed by Padmāṅkuravajra on the fourth chapter of the Hevajra Tantra, set out in sequence and called "The Condensed Meaning of the Sealing."

"In the direction of Śakra (Indra)" means the east. The passage beginning "At the eastern gate" means abiding on the lotus petals of the eastern gate. In this order come Gaurī, Caurī, Vetālī, and Ghasmarī. They should be imagined on the lotus petals of the gates. If one asks how what is produced from a single seed syllable becomes countless: in reply, through the distinctions of purity they become many in number. For example, a single wrathful one is the lord of the wheel, also serves as a gatekeeper, and also abides in the protection wheel. Thus he is seen in three places. In the same way, Gaurī and the others become gatekeepers and so forth. Their colors, too, should be understood by way of the distinctions of their purities. The Tathāgata declares its meaning: according to the distinctions of the body colors of the deities of the image maṇḍala, the eight hand emblems should be drawn. Depending on the purpose seen in them, some become eight, some thirteen, and some even fifteen. For example, by name they are called the ten wrathful ones, yet when a purpose is seen they also become fourteen. Therefore there is no fault.

"The victorious vase (vijayakalaśa)": because it is the principal one, it is called the victorious vase. It should be understood to be the lord of the maṇḍala. Furthermore, the eight vases of the eight goddesses should be understood. At the side of the gate, in order to drive away obstructors, one should imagine one vase, making exactly ten. That is the principle of the tantra. It is said, "One should not make fewer than ten."

"Enjoyment": the time of experiencing the awakening mind is called "enjoyment." Its meaning is that one should restrain the breath of the nose and the breath of the mouth and carry it downward. Or else, "enjoyment" means that at the time of directly perceiving the nondual meditative absorption that one realizes for oneself, one should not form thoughts of outer and inner. "Then" means that the two conceptual thoughts come to cease. The lines "Likewise the pure maiden, just as it arises there" mean this: because the sphere of the mind is declared to be one, there arises a bliss free of afflictions, a wisdom endowed with the power to work for the benefit of sentient beings for as long as saṃsāra exists.

This completes the commentary composed by Padmāṅkuravajra on the fifth chapter of the Hevajra Tantra, the section on the Manifestation.

The unsurpassed Dharma is taught; that is why this king of tantras was spoken. Therefore a sādhana with a painted image is not appropriate. That it is taught in other tantras is for the sake of those devoted to outer forms. Its meaning is: "For the sake of those devoted to the outer, painted images and the like were taught." In reply to this: a yogin who abides in other tantras, being devoted to the outer, sees the painted image move and so forth and says, "My accomplishment is near." If a yogin who abides in this one paints a painted image just as the Tathāgata taught, the yogin will not be confused about the faces, the arms, and so forth. By seeing it, he also becomes familiar with the yoga. The Tathāgatas, too, will bless him. In this way he will attain the accomplishment of the Great Seal (mahāmudrā). Therefore the sādhana with a painted image does not become a fault, nor does it become conceptual thought about externals.

This completes the commentary composed by Padmāṅkuravajra on the sixth chapter of the Hevajra Tantra, the section on the Image.

Twelve finger-widths was stated so that it can be hidden in the hand and so forth. Here all of the Dharma is taught in condensed form. Wisdom is not of the nature of conceptual elaboration. Sentient beings who dwell in elaboration will

not understand what is higher. Therefore sentient beings who dwell in elaboration, not having seen the book, say, "This is not the scripture of the Tathāgata." A person without sacred commitment who disparages the words that convey the true Dharma will be born in hell. And if a yogin shows the precious words of the Tathāgata to one without sacred commitment, his sacred commitment will be damaged, and therefore he will not attain the accomplishment of the Great Seal. Its meaning is taught in the passage beginning "In this life there is no accomplishment."

"The maṇḍala of the gathering (gaṇamaṇḍala)" means countless disciples with the guru presiding at their head. "Accomplishing every desired aim" means that the yogin will obtain the common accomplishments and the uncommon accomplishment. This shows that he is endowed with the power to teach those who abide in the three vehicles according to their wishes. Imagining the master as like the principal deity at the center of the maṇḍala, one should give him a seat in the center. Imagining the disciples as like the deities of the maṇḍala, one should give them seats. Then, having blessed the food, the vegetables, and so forth as ambrosia, and abiding oneself in the meditative absorption of the deity, one should imagine a hūṃ on the tongue of everyone and imagine that, through its transformation, each tongue takes on the nature of a vajra. Having done so, one should eat, drink, and so forth. By constantly cultivating this, one will constantly see the maṇḍala in the mind. Through constantly seeing it in this way, the vajra-like meditative absorption will arise. When it has arisen, one comes to possess the power to destroy such things as the obscurations of the afflictions and the rest. Then one becomes free of the two obscurations. Free of them, it is the nature of the three bodies: unsurpassed in essence, without obscuration, unceasing, by nature great bliss, and endowed with the power to accomplish the benefit of the immeasurable realms of sentient beings. One will attain awakening such as this. Therefore, practicing meditative absorption while eating and so forth is only a sign; what is taught is that one should practice meditative absorption at all times. It is that itself which is to be constantly practiced; eating and the like are not what is to be practiced. Its meaning is taught in the passage beginning "The image of Hevajra is oneself, right at the center."

This completes the commentary composed by Padmāṅkuravajra on the seventh chapter of the Hevajra Tantra, the section on the Method of Eating.

Through the yogin's possessing the accumulation of merit, and through the power of his meditative absorption, a bodhisattva comes under his sway. That

bodhisattva, having taken the form of a woman, will come. She is called the Great Seal. Or else, a bodhisattva abiding on a lower ground is born as a woman by reason of a particular karma. She is called the Great Seal. To show her characteristics, it is taught in the passage beginning "Or else, neither tall nor short."

The line "First, give the discipline of the fast" only indicates this by a token. Abandoning the taking of life, taking what is not given, unchaste conduct, false speech, and grain liquor and prepared liquor is called the vow of a lay practitioner (upāsaka). Perfumes, flower garlands, ointments, song, dance, drumming, high seats, large seats, and food at the wrong time: when these are added to the above, they make eight. These eight are called the vow of the fast (upavāsa). When not touching gold and silver is added to these, they are called the ten precepts of a novice. In this sequence, having abandoned the nonvirtuous actions of body, speech, and mind, one should understand precisely what has just been explained. The Tathāgata has spoken of its meaning. If one asks how he spoke of it, he said, "The five, the eight, and the ten are to be abandoned." By abandoning these, one becomes a lay practitioner, an observer of the fast, a novice, and so forth. Its meaning is taught by the words "After that, the ten precepts."

In the passage beginning "Then teach the Vaibhāṣika," what is taught is the awakening of the śrāvakas (hearers) and the awakening of the pratyekabuddhas. I shall show how this is heard. The form aggregate and the rest are called "time." Why are they called "time"? Because they have the nature of the four, the past and the rest. They are called "suffering." Why are they called "suffering"? Because they have the nature of suffering. Further, there are their emptiness and their selflessness. By these words, the five aggregates that are results are called the truth of suffering; this is what is experienced now. Insofar as they are its cause, they are called the truth of origin. The cessation of these two is called the truth of cessation. It is of two kinds: cessation through analysis and cessation not through analysis. And since it is not attained without the path, one should contemplate the truth of the path. Its synonyms are these: it is also called "reasoning," also called "the wheel," and also called "the five aggregates." This is called the awakening of the śrāvakas and the pratyekabuddhas.

These words teach this meaning: the śrāvakas and the others, seeing saṃsāra as suffering, abandon it, and apply the means by which they will not be born again later. One should meditate on the four noble truths, taking them as

valid. Among them, suffering is to be known, origin is to be abandoned, cessation is to be actualized, and the path is to be cultivated. Therefore one should examine the nature of the five aggregates. If one asks how one should examine it: it is like, for example, an illness, the cause of the illness, freedom from the illness, and the medicine. Suffering is like the illness. Origin is like the cause of the illness. Cessation is like freedom from the illness. The path is like the medicine.

For whoever examines the four noble truths in this way, eight knowledges and eight forbearances (kṣānti) will arise. These are called the sixteen moments. This is called the path of seeing, the light of world-transcending wisdom. Because it sees what had not been directly seen, it is called the path of seeing. Because it realizes cessation in direct perception, it is called a path. Here the moments are: the Dharma knowledge of suffering, the forbearance for the Dharma knowledge of suffering, the subsequent Dharma knowledge of suffering, and the forbearance for the subsequent Dharma knowledge of suffering; the Dharma knowledge of origin, the forbearance for the Dharma knowledge of origin, the subsequent Dharma knowledge of origin, and the forbearance for the subsequent Dharma knowledge of origin; the Dharma knowledge of cessation, the forbearance for the Dharma knowledge of cessation, the subsequent Dharma knowledge of cessation, and the forbearance for the subsequent Dharma knowledge of cessation; the Dharma knowledge of the path, the forbearance for the Dharma knowledge of the path, the subsequent Dharma knowledge of the path, and the forbearance for the subsequent Dharma knowledge of the path. These make sixteen.

By cultivating the path of seeing in this sequence, one abandons the eighty-eight afflictions of the three realms that are to be abandoned by seeing, and so forth. Among them, the twelve to be abandoned by seeing suffering are the view of permanence, the view of self, the view of annihilation, the view of the perishing collection (satkāyadṛṣṭi), the view that holds moral discipline and ascetic observances to be supreme, doubt, attachment, aversion, pride, and ignorance. As for the seven to be abandoned by seeing origin: leaving out from those above the view of permanence, the view of self, and the view of the perishing collection, the remainder are the seven to be abandoned by seeing origin. Those to be abandoned by seeing cessation accord with these. The six to be abandoned by seeing the path are attachment, aversion, pride, ignorance, holding moral discipline and ascetic observances to be supreme, and doubt: six. By abandoning the thirty-two of the desire realm that are to be

abandoned by seeing, and the four to be abandoned by meditation, one is not born in the desire realm. Doubt, attachment, aversion, pride, and ignorance. Apart from these, one born in the form realm is to abandon the thirty-one that are to be abandoned by seeing. In the formless realm it is the same. By abandoning the eighty-eight and so forth that are to be abandoned by seeing, one is free of the causes of birth in the three realms. Being free of them is called being free of attachment to the three realms. This is what is called a śrāvaka buddha and a pratyekabuddha. Because they are free of the afflictions, they are not born in saṃsāra. Therefore it is called nirvāṇa. It is like, for example, a lamp that has gone out.

If one asks what difference there is between a śrāvaka and a pratyekabuddha: having heard from a perfectly complete buddha, the śrāvaka too becomes a perfectly complete buddha.

Through these he explains the Dharma and trains sentient beings. Because they listen when urged by others, "Listen!", they are called śrāvakas, "hearers." As for the pratyekabuddha: having earlier retained what he himself had heard, he understands his own awakening without depending on the instructions of others, and so he is called a pratyekabuddha, one awakened by himself. Giving up explanation by means of words, he establishes sentient beings in the ten virtues by means of his body. Its meaning is this: because he understands by himself, without relying on the instructions of others, and awakens by himself, his wisdom is truly profound; therefore he is designated by the name "self-victor."

Viewing the five aggregates, which are without self, as self and as belonging to a self is called the view of permanence. Viewing in this way the aggregates and so forth, which are without self, as a self, and viewing that, moreover, as permanent, is called the view of self. Not harming others is called moral discipline. There is dwelling in such places as the ground where dogs lie, the track that many cattle tread, and the ground where wild animals live. Further, lying on ashes, shaving off the hair, going to bathe at places where sages have bathed, eating fruits and roots, wearing matted locks, wearing bark garments, and so forth are called ascetic observances. Practicing in this way is called holding moral discipline and ascetic observances to be supreme. Being of two minds about the truths and the Jewels is called doubt. Clinging to the three realms is called attachment. The arising of aversion toward sentient beings or toward what are not sentient beings is called aversion.

Pride has the characteristic of an inflated mind. It is of seven kinds: pride, the pride of being greater, pride beyond pride, the pride of thinking "I am," the pride of being only slightly less, and wrong pride. "The pride of being greater" is this: being greater in family, good looks, wealth, and learning; because these far exceed those of others, it is the pride of being greater. "Pride beyond pride" is this: although one is equal in those things above, thinking, "I am greater even than him," is called pride beyond pride. As for the pride of thinking "I am": though one is equal in family, thinking "I am greater" on account of looks, learning, wealth, and moral discipline is called the pride of thinking "I am." "The pride of presumption" is this: saying, "He has a view of self, but I have no view of self," and saying, "I know the world-transcending Dharma, but he does not know the world-transcending Dharma," is called the pride of presumption. Thinking oneself lesser in family and so forth by only a little is called the pride of being only slightly less. Saying, "I have good qualities," while having no good qualities is called wrong pride.

Ignorance: because it obscures knowing, it is called ignorance. Or else, not knowing the truth of suffering and the rest is called ignorance. These afflictions are called what binds sentient beings to saṃsāra. Or else, because they afflict one's very being, made of body, speech, and mind, they are called afflictions.

Then the line "Then the Yogācāra" is stated. Now the awakening of the Yogācāra is taught. To show this: whoever holds objects such as form to be ultimately external takes as ultimate what the Tathāgata taught by force of an underlying intention. When examined as one or many, that is not ultimate. If one asks, "If that is not ultimate, what is this aspect of definiteness in place, time, and so forth?", in reply: it is holding cognition to be external, by force of not having abandoned the habitual tendencies of erroneous conceptual thought since immeasurable time. The Tathāgata has spoken of its meaning. If one asks how he spoke of it: in the noble Buddhāvataṃsaka he said, "O children of the Victor, these three realms are mind only." Therefore, by meditating on mind only, one attains awakening.

Cognition, being of the nature of cognition, is called true. The external aspect, not being of the nature of cognition, is called false. By that reasoning, since the external is not true, the five aggregates, whose nature is suffering and origin, are not true either. The afflictions they produce are not true either. By knowing this, one becomes free of the obscuration of the afflictions. Since form and the rest do not exist ultimately, they are not objects to be grasped.

Whoever knows it in this way becomes free of the obscuration of the knowable. One who is free of these two is called a Tathāgata. This teaches the awakening of the Yogācāra.

The awakening of the Madhyamaka is to be taught, and so the line "After that, teach the Madhyamaka" is stated. Here one may ask: above, cognition was called true because it is of the nature of cognition; is that something existent, or else something nonexistent? Is it of an existent nature? Does it exist as one, or does it exist as many? If it exists as a single nature, there is this fault: why, for example, would a picture and the like be differentiated? Because it appears as differentiated, it is not one. If it were one, the picture and the like appearing as differentiated would be false. If one asks why it would be false: because it appears as manifold. And its appearing as manifold is due to manifold causes. In it there is no sign of oneness. Here "one" means this: seeing the manifold in a single instant is called "one." Are that instant and the manifold one, or are they distinct? If they are distinct, you would be right; but if they are not distinct, it is not true. And it is not true, because past time and the rest do not exist apart from it. Therefore it is not one. Nor is it many: since the nature of one is not established when examined, many is not true either. Because external objects are not established under the reasoning of one and many, consciousness likewise does not exist either.

Then how does it exist? It exists like a reflection in a mirror and the like. If it exists in that way, what is it that becomes a buddha? In reply: it is the conceptual thought of outer and inner that is removed; the intrinsic nature is not nonexistent. If one asks what is meant by "intrinsic nature": it is being free of stains by nature. Moreover, it is what one understands oneself and cannot express to others in words.

Moreover, outer and inner things are empty by their intrinsic nature. With regard to this, the direct realization of natural peace, free of such elaborations as hearing, reflecting, and constant mindfulness, is called omniscience. As for its meaning, the Perfection of Wisdom in Twenty-Five Thousand Lines says: "Subhūti, by possessing what does one become omniscient? What is its intrinsic nature? What is its master?" On this, "By possessing what does one become omniscient?" means that one becomes omniscient by possessing emptiness. "What is its intrinsic nature?" means that its intrinsic nature is peace. "What is its master?" means mindfulness.

On "Having understood all the mantra tantras": "mantra" is the seed syllable. When it is transformed, the body of the deity becomes complete. Through that body is taught the purity of the aggregates, the elements, the sense sources, and the phenomena of all the Tathāgatas. If one asks where this is taught: having understood it just as it is taught in the Glorious Ornament of the Vajra Essence Tantra, the maṇḍala of Dharmadhātu Vāgīśvara (the Lord of Speech), and other sources, one should begin the Hevajra Tantra, which condenses what is to be known of the unsurpassed Dharma. "One should begin" means "one should listen to it." Knowing in this way, one will not fall into these three: not understanding, understanding wrongly, and understanding with doubt. Therefore one will be endowed with earnestness, and one will also attain the accomplishments.

The commentary on the eighth chapter of the Hevajra Tantra, composed by Padmāṅkuravajra, is complete.

Those meant are those who harm the Three Jewels, those who break their commitments, and those who revile the guru. Because they act in this way, they will be born in hell. Therefore one should be wrathful, with compassion. Having been drawn forth, the wisdom being (jñānasattva) dwelling in one's own heart should declare the faults of the one just described to the deities of his body and so on, and say, "You must abandon this one!" Then one should imagine the deities of his body and so on being carried off and dissolving into one's own body, speech, and mind. Imagining his consciousness as a bodhisattva, one should place it in the realm of Sukhāvatī and have it listen to the Dharma. Then, imagining his body to be like an empty house, and imagining further that it is devoid of deities and of mind, one should imagine countless wrathful ones seizing countless weapons and cutting it apart and so forth. Further, one should imagine it being devoured by vultures and the like and by jackals and the like. Further, one should drive blazing vajra needles into his secret passage and elsewhere. One should also imagine the lotus at his navel being burned and reduced to ash. One should also imagine him being struck with hammers. One should imagine that at his heart the syllable raṃ transforms into a blazing maṇḍala of fire, and that, burned by it, he is reduced to ash. In such a sequence liberation is taught.

The passage beginning "The act of killing is to be done with compassion" should be understood as explained above. On "the eyes": if one asks why the sense of the dual is expressed, the dual form is used so that the two-armed Heruka may be understood. Yet it is not that one alone whose eyes are red: it

is to be understood of all of them.

"The four means of attraction" are generosity, pleasant speech, consistency of aim, and purposeful conduct.

"The seven limbs of awakening" are the limb of perfect awakening that is mindfulness, the limb of awakening that is knowing phenomena, the limb of awakening that is diligence, the limb of awakening that is joy, the limb of awakening that is freedom from laziness, the limb of awakening that is meditative absorption, and the limb of awakening that is equanimity. "The limb of perfect awakening that is mindfulness" is remembering the aspiration one made before to attain buddhahood for the sake of sentient beings, and remembering what one has heard, and so on. "The limb of awakening that is knowing phenomena" is knowing all phenomena as emptiness. Wanting to become familiar with that again and again is called the limb of awakening that is diligence. The joy free of afflictions that arises from meditating on it is called the limb of awakening that is joy. Because through it body, speech, and mind are made free of laziness in carrying out their tasks, this is called the limb of awakening that is freedom from laziness. The mind's becoming one-pointed on the four immeasurables and on suchness is called the limb of awakening that is meditative absorption. Regarding the faults of all sentient beings with equanimity and holding to good qualities such as the perfections is called the limb of awakening that is equanimity.

The commentary on the ninth chapter of the Hevajra Tantra, composed by Padmāṅkuravajra, is complete.

For pacifying, one should visualize the mantra as white. For bringing under control, one should visualize it as red. For immobilizing, one should visualize it as yellow. For enriching, one should visualize it as reddish yellow. For summoning, one should visualize it as red. For killing and for sowing enmity, one should visualize it as black. For pacifying, one should make the mind peaceful. For bringing under control, the yogin should set his mind in an amorous mode. For summoning, one should have a heroic mind. For immobilizing, one should adopt a malign mind. For enriching, one should adopt a mind of compassion. For sowing enmity, the yogin should take on a form that terrifies others. For killing, one should be in a mind of extreme wrath. Taking up the rosary as it was taught, one should recite. For pacifying and the rest, one should recite in the regular order; for killing and the rest, one should recite reversing the order.

The commentary on the tenth chapter of the Hevajra Tantra, composed by Padmāṅkuravajra, is complete.

"Garden": a place where people without commitments do not dwell, and which is pleasing to the yogin, is called a garden. "Worship" means that, through the sequence of the fivefold manifest awakening, one should generate oneself in the body of the two-armed Heruka and carry out the blessing of the sense sources and so on. He has one face and three eyes. Having done so, one should act toward the wisdom consort (prajñā) in whatever way delights her, with outer things such as camphor and inner things such as the sun. "Again and again" means "constantly." "Below" is the lotus. "Above" is the mouth. Touching the lotus with the mouth, one should act in whatever way the wisdom consort comes to delight.

Alternatively, "below" is the common accomplishment, and "above" is the uncommon accomplishment. Forming the intention to give those two accomplishments to all sentient beings, one should, through the guru's oral instruction, rouse and command Vajradhātvīśvarī, who was taught earlier.

I shall show the meaning of the joy of intrinsic nature:

When the yogin views gnosis,
He abides in bliss and does not come out of it,
For a single watch (prahar), or else for a single day,
For half a month, a month, or a year,
For a single aeon, or else a thousand aeons.
The one who so abides is endowed with gnosis.
By attaining the vast and exceedingly great accomplishment,
He is like all the buddhas.

By finding such an accomplishment, one comes to possess the Dharma body (dharmakāya) and the rest.

The commentary on the eleventh chapter of the Hevajra Tantra, composed by Padmāṅkuravajra, is complete.

As for the empowerments taught earlier, I shall present the verses: they are taught in the passage beginning "Great Hevajra." Furthermore, the revealing of the maṇḍala, the water empowerment, the crown empowerment, the vajra empowerment, the bell empowerment, the name empowerment, and so on are called the vase empowerment.

Having summoned all the Tathāgatas, one should imagine them entering one's mouth. When that has melted, one should hold it firm at the tip of the two-pointed vajra, draw it out from the flower, and let it fall into the disciple's mouth. That is called the secret empowerment.

One abides in the meditative absorption of the two-pointed vajra and the flower. The gnosis that arises between supreme bliss and the joy free from passion has an intrinsic nature free of the three: passion, freedom from passion, and the intermediate. Moreover, it has the intrinsic nature of a bliss that is understood by oneself and free of afflictions. That is called the wisdom-gnosis empowerment (prajñājñāna). Through the guru's oral instruction, such gnosis comes to arise. Remaining for as long as saṃsāra exists, it knows the minds of sentient beings throughout the measureless realm of beings and acts for their benefit. Causing it to be understood in this way is called the fourth empowerment. Since there is no gnosis more supreme beyond this, the empowerments are taught as four.

The commentary on the second part (kalpa) of the Hevajra Tantra, composed by Padmāṅkuravajra, is complete.

Everything, in all its aspects,
The Tathāgata is able to teach.
Knowing this, learned ones, listen:
It was by the power of compassion.
I myself have a mind that clings;
Compassion roused my mind.
It was made by one without true knowledge;
Learned ones, please show forbearance.

I have unravelled this scripture of great meaning;
By whatever root of virtue I have gained from it,
May the minds of all sentient beings
Become an abode of the Three Jewels and the rest.

The commentary on the king of tantras called Hevajra, composed by the master Padmāṅkuravajrapāda, who knew one thousand four hundred sūtras, is complete.

At the request made to the great Indian preceptor Padmākara by Tsurtön Yikgi Gyaltsen and others:

Rinchen Barwa, the least among the renowned disciples
Of the revered Lama Deshek,
Weak in understanding and the like, unskilled in the language of India,
Translated this commentary on the difficult points of Hevajra;
May the foremost scholars and venerable ones not find fault with it.
By this root of virtue from translating with faith aroused,
May the minds of all sentient beings of the three realms
Become perfectly free of the two obscurations.

Translator's Notes

• The thirty-two channels are given their Sanskrit names from the Hevajra Tantra's list, identified by order and meaning; this text's Tibetan renderings sometimes differ. "Pramāṇā" renders tshad ma, where the Hevajra has Pravaṇā; the channel in Viyogā's place is rendered "joiner of the cause-body," and Māradārikā "harlot of Māra's deeds." The list here omits Surūpiṇī and adds Karkatani, written as the Tibetan spells it. For Śītadā the text reads grangs sbyin, taken as a slip for grang sbyin, "cold-giver." Some locations are obscure: "the joint" (tshigs pa, perhaps a vertebra), "the lower end of the leg" (rgyu zhabs, perhaps the ankle), and "the supreme one" (mchog ma), probably the central channel. "The two testicles" renders 'bras bu gnyis, literally "the two fruits." The "self-arisen flower" is the female generative fluid, paired with bodhicitta, the male fluid. The "sixty-four yak-tail whisks" (rnga yab, cāmara) seem to be units in a reckoning of breath or time; their sense is unclear.
• The author's name, given in the colophons as Padma'i myu gu rdo rje and, in the second, with the order Padma'i rdo rje myu gu ("Lotus-Sprout Vajra"), is rendered Padmāṅkuravajra. In "the completion of the wisdom consort's body," the text's sū is read as sku, "body," as in the parallel phrase that follows. The list of minor accomplishments may intend "the practice of chalk" and "accomplishment" as two separate rites, which would give eight, matching Hevajra and the seven goddesses assigned to them.
• The words rendered "faintly smiling" (bag zhad) in the quoted line "Blue in color, faintly smiling, red" are obscure. The text says sound is of eight kinds but names six; the standard Abhidharma eight come from combining these pairs. Its "produced" and "unproduced" sound correspond to the Abhidharma distinction between sound from great elements that are, and are not, appropriated by a living body.
• "Six families" (rigs drug) here means the five buddha families together with Vajradhara, not the six classes of beings. The four lights of gnosis echo the four stages of the path of joining (heat, peak, forbearance, and supreme dharma), given here in this text's own order.
• The fifth ground is first named sbyang dka' ba and then explained as rgyal bar dka' ba; both render the Sanskrit Sudurjayā, so one English name, Hard to Conquer, is used for both. The text does not say outright that the bodhisattva enters the third ground; the sentence beginning "Having entered that ground" refers to it, as the perfection of patience and the name Luminous show.
• □□□□□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□□□□□ ("when ..., the seventh ground"), and □□□ as □□□□ ("there"). □□□□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as "the qualities of the whole" (□□□ "entire"), in contrast to "a mere portion" of the ground. In □□□□□□□□□□□□□

sealing and opening the exits of the consciousness. "Great field" (□□□□□□□) is the tantric code word for a human corpse.
• In the root line □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, □□□□□ is read as "the other" (as in □□□□□□□□□□ "the others" later in this passage), not as a negation; this matches the commentary's gloss "the second tier." Copyists' slips read: □□□□□□□□□ as □□□□□□□□□ ("adorned with snakes"), □□□□□ as □□□□□ ("petal"), and □□□□□□ as □□□□□ ("in answer"). In the account of the joys, □□□□□□□ renders sahaja, "the innate," as the parallel lines show ("the innate is devoid of these"; "the innate cannot be taught by another"). Here bodhicitta and "the self-arisen flower" are the tantric terms for the male and female generative essences.
• "Camphor" (□□□□□) is the tantric code word for semen, the bodhicitta, so "not giving up the camphor" refers to its retention in union; "the stirring" is the movement of union. In the root line quoted as □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, □□□□□□□ is taken as a creeper (compare dbyi mong, clematis). In the root line □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, □□□□□ ("transformed") may stand for □□□□, giving "the form aggregate is Vajrā". "Determinate" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) here comprises the virtuous and the nonvirtuous, as against the morally indeterminate.
• The list of the eight liberations is translated as it stands: it names seven items and places infinite consciousness before infinite space. In "Or else, take any one there," □□□ is taken as the imperative of □□□□, "take"; the gloss shows that the line concerns the consort, who may be of any family. In the gloss on the immobilizing gaze, □□□ ("anus") before "left" makes no sense and is passed over as a slip; □□□□□ is taken as "slightly," and □□ ("five") is read as □□ ("look").
• The syllables na and ga are probably the initials of code words for the sacramental meats (Skt. nara, human; go, cow). In the gloss on purifying the image, □□□□□□ is unclear and is taken as □□, "the deity." In the colophons, □□□□□ is taken as standing for kalpa, "section," as in kalparāja, and the chapter title rendered "Conception" (□□□□□□) may likewise stand for kalpa; these titles are uncertain. □□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□, "restraint." "The diverse" (□□□□□□□□□) is taken as the first of the four moments (vicitra).
• The consort is designated throughout by doctrinal epithets: the Dharma-Nature in the secret empowerment and the Emptiness in the wisdom-gnosis empowerment; the commentary itself glosses "consort" as "the Emptiness," and "wisdom" in the master's verse also refers to her. "Vairocana and the rest" in her questions are code names for the sacramental substances, as the disciple's reply (excrement, urine) shows. Saṃvara in the verse on union renders the house term, but there it denotes the supreme bliss of union rather than the deity.
• The Tibetan reads "therefore one should not eat everything." The negative contradicts the argument it concludes (freedom from accepting and rejecting) and the verse then cited, which names substances to be consumed, so it is taken as a copyist's slip carried over from the string of prohibitions just before, and the evident sense "one should eat everything" is translated. "Arrests" renders rengs par byed pa (Skt. stambhana), the retention of the awakening mind, here the seminal essence, in the practice of union; camphor below is likewise a coded term for this white essence.
The verse on the emanation body parallels the Abhisamayālaṃkāra's verse on the nirmāṇakāya in a divergent rendering and is translated as it stands; the lists that follow track that work's qualities of the dharmakāya, the "bases of wisdom" answering to the spheres of mastery (abhibhvāyatana) and the absorption that dispels turmoil to the araṇā samādhi.
• "Upper bodies" follows the evident reading stod for the written stong ("empty"), which makes no sense beside smad, "lower body."
"Was overwhelmed" renders the obscure phrase dam pa skyes te (literally "the sublime arose"); the sense is taken from the fainting that follows and the doubt just voiced.
The sentence placing "the secret" in the four intermediate directions, above, and below is obscure as written, and the list of guardians that follows also covers the four cardinal directions; it is translated as it stands.

• The quoted lines rendered "Likewise the pure maiden, just as it arises there" are obscure as they stand in this Tibetan, and the commentary's gloss does not settle their construction; they are translated literally.
• The numbers are given as the text has them: it says the aggregates have the nature of "the four" times beginning with the past, where the Abhidharma usually counts three, and it numbers those abandoned by seeing suffering as twelve while naming ten (the total of thirty-two for the desire realm assumes twelve). "The remainder" follows the evident reading lhag ma for the written ltag ma.
• Four evident readings are translated where the written syllables make no sense: "without relying" (la ma brten par for lam brten par), "eating" fruits and roots (za ba for zab), "far exceed" (che bas for cha bas), and "binds sentient beings to saṃsāra" ('brel bar for 'bral bar, "separates," since the afflictions are what tie beings to saṃsāra).
The text says pride is of seven kinds but lists six; the seventh, the pride of presumption, is missing from the list though it is defined below. Its definitions of the views of permanence and of self also differ from the usual Abhidharma ones. Both are translated as they stand.
• Evident scribal slips are read as corrected: smra, "say," for smu; tho bas, "with hammers," for thobs; yan lag, "limb," for yang dag in the gloss on knowing phenomena; and 'gyur ba de bzhin du for 'gyur bde bzhin du. In the sentence on reciting in the regular order, mdza' ba, "friendship," makes no sense; it is read as bzla ba, "recite," as the next sentence has it. The Tibetan title dpal rdo rje snying po rgyan gyi rgyud is shared by the Vajrahṛdayālaṃkāra and the Vajramaṇḍālaṃkāra tantras, so its meaning is translated. This text's list of the seven limbs of awakening has freedom from laziness where the usual list has pliancy (prasrabdhi), and its four means of attraction place consistency of aim before purposeful conduct; both are translated as they stand.
• In the account of the third empowerment, bde mchog is not the deity Saṃvara but "supreme bliss," one of the stages of joy: the innate gnosis is placed between supreme bliss and the joy free from passion. In the author's closing verse, blo ni zhen pa ("a mind that clings") is translated as written; it may be a slip for blo ni zhan pa, "weak in understanding," the usual formula of humility, as in the translator's blo zhan. The translator's teacher, bla ma bde gshegs zhabs, could not be identified; the name is given in Tibetan phonetics as Lama Deshek.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.